Footnotes

[a] In Napoleon's luggage, captured on the retreat from Moscow, was found a portfolio full of 'the reports, maps, and routes, drawn up by General Gardane at the request of the Emperor', for the invasion of India which he was still planning to pull off after the subjection of Russia. NAI, Foreign, Secret Consultations, 19 August 1825, nos 3–4.

[b] What is left of Nadir Shah's Mughal loot is still kept locked up in the vaults of Bank Meli in Teheran. This includes the 'sister' of the Koh-i-Nur, the Dariya Nur, or Ocean of Light.

[c] The same was often true in India: Clive's 'victories' at Plassey and Buxar were actually more like successful negotiations between British bankers and Indian power brokers than the triumphs of arms and valour that imperial propaganda later made them out to be.

[d] The British later learned to follow the Mughal model. According to a piece of imperial doggerel it became British policy to 'Thrash the Sindhis, make friends with the Baluch, but pay the Pathans.'

[e] Mubarak Haveli still survives in Lahore's old city, a five-minute walk from the Punjab Archives in Anarkali where much of the research for this book was done. The haveli [courtyard house] is still as it was in Shah Shuja's day, with a succession of courtyards giving on to living quarters reached through wooden fretwork lattices and carved balconies. After the First Afghan War it was given by the British to exiled Qizilbash leaders from Kabul and it remains a centre of Shia activity today, with its own ashurkhana in the furthest courtyard. When I was last there a bomb went off outside the haveli as a Shia Muharram procession left the building, and the area now has a strong police presence.

[f] Mubarak Haveli has a large underground cool room, or tykhana, which apparently dates from this period. Its existence must have made the breakout much more feasible than it at first appears.

[g] The Afghan war artist James Rattray claims in the notes to his celebrated Afghan lithographs that it was Wa'fa Begum, not Shuja, who organised his escape (as well as her own), and he calls her conduct 'an example of coolness and intrepidity'. It seems unlikely that even Wa'fa Begum could have organised the tunnelling and boatmen from across the Company border in Ludhiana, but it is a measure of the extent to which the legend of Wa'fa's abilities had flourished that Rattray was told this thirty years later, long after her death. See James Rattray, *The costumes of the Various Tribes, Portraits of Ladies of Rank, Celebrated Princes and Chiefs, Views of the Principal Fortresses and Cities, and Interior of the Cities and Temples of Afghaunistaun,* London, 1848, p. 29.

[h] The Shikarpuri Sindhi money-lending community had long specialised in financing wars and dealing in arms, and the tradition continues to this day: the most notable Shikarpuris in this business today are the Hinduja brothers, who, among many other such deals, were allegedly involved in the controversial sale of the Bofors guns to Rajiv Gandhi's government in the 1980s.